Then it’s all there again. The softness of the sound of the ball hitting wicketkeeper gloves. The teammates, the crowd, the sense of an outside world watching. I’m the centre of it, for one last time. At the end of the game, Josh Da Silva is walking past me: ‘That was a privilege,’ he says, ‘to get out to you like that.’

As I turn to say goodbye, raising my hat and waving for the last time, it suddenly occurs to me how much time I have spent at Lord’s. That, incredibly, for someone from Burnley, someone who found this place so distant and daunting and overawing, it feels like a home to me now. I would usually walk off as quickly as I could, just to get away from it all, back to the safety of the dressing room. This time, just this once, I take it all in and turn 360 degrees, waving, seeing a lifetime in the stands.

The crowd are still there when Mike Atherton interviews me back over the ground PA, another clipped up ‘*This Is Your Life*’ just having played out. ‘You’ve got to have a sadistic side to be a fast bowler,’ I remember telling him, ‘because it does hurt. I won’t miss getting out of bed and not being able to sit on the toilet first thing in the morning or lift my arms to brush my teeth.’ I hear the laughter of 31,000 people and don’t have the energy to tell them this isn’t a joke. ‘Test cricket is the perfect game,’ I tell Athers. ‘It shows you how much you’ve got inside you and how deep you can actually dig.’ And what about Gus Atkinson’s debut after record figures?, he prompts. I smile, ‘I will say, it’s downhill from here.’

The interview, the wickets and the walk off are not my abiding memories when I’m waking up on that bench, trying to put the rest of the night together, working out what to answer this stranger who’s asking me if I miss it that much already. I just remember, with a new kind of profound satisfaction, chasing the ball to the boundary on that third morning, trying to stop a four that would have been completely inconsequential to the game. I was determined to catch it, running down the slope at Lord’s and as I did, throwing my cap off in a final chase of sudden abandon, I remembered how I fell in love with cricket, where it all began; not with the bat or the ball, but just the pure joy of throwing yourself at a ball for your team in the field, even to save one meaningless run.